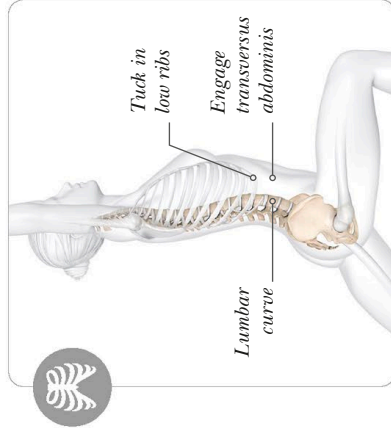


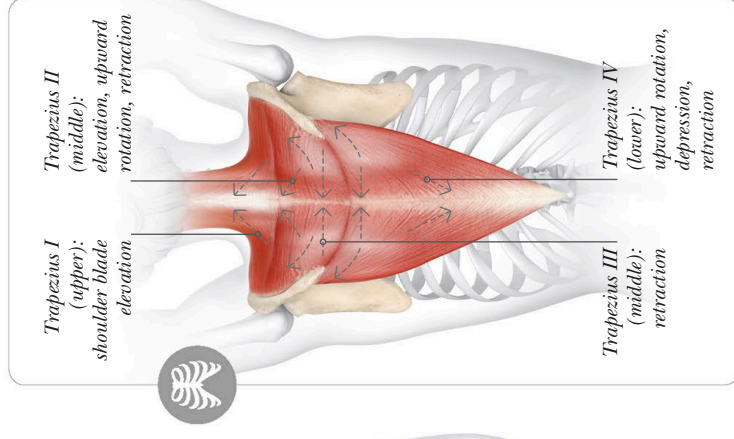
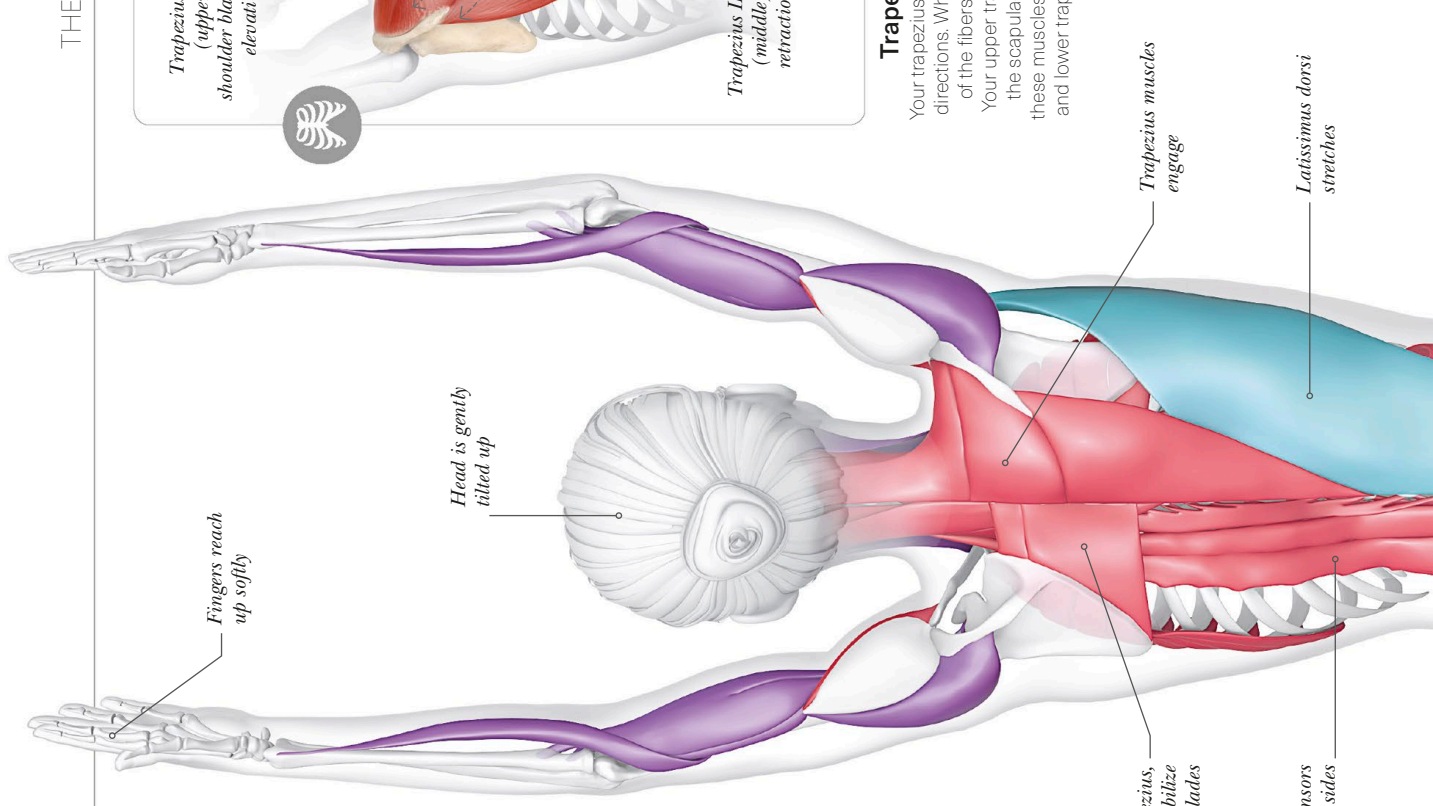
» CLOSER LOOK

You may try modifications to find comfort and efficient alignment. This pose presents an opportunity to consciously release common “stress” and “fear” muscles like the upper trapezius and psoas major.



Spinal flexibility

Highly flexible people often allow their pelvic bowl to tilt forward, creating an extreme arch in the spine (see pp.14–15). If this is you, bring in your low ribs and engage your abdominals, particularly your transversus abdominis. However, don't overcompensate by tucking the tailbone and losing the lumbar curve.



Trapezius recruitment

Your trapezius has three parts, and four fiber directions. When you flex your shoulders, all of the fibers engage to varying degrees. Your upper traps engage slightly to elevate the scapulae, though many overengage these muscles, causing tension. Your middle and lower traps should be the main players.

Deep to the trapezius, your rhomboids stabilize your shoulder blades

Spinal extensors engage on both sides